Email to the supervising professors — research-side companion

Status: v0-3 draft text as of 2026-11-09, in two variants. Variant A replaces the code-side email if it has **not yet** been sent, and carries both sides in one message with one one-pager. Variant B follows the code-side email if it **has** been sent. Attachments in either case: the research-side 01, 02, 03 (as PDF) and the one-page AI-use disclosure and agreement (to be drafted at G-SD1 Stage 1 and edited in my own words before sending).

Variant A — one email, both sides (preferred if the first email has not gone)

Subject: CVIN — where the thesis stands, November 2026

Hi Professor [A], Professor [B],

An informal note to re-open the thread before a proper update. I know it has been a long while, and that's on me.

The work of the past year has two sides, and I'm sending one page for each, plus two short documents behind them.

The Thesis on One Page — one for the applied system (nine identity standards implemented and measured on a vehicle lifecycle, with five questions and six hypotheses and their measured verdicts) and one for the research side (the twelve-function interface derived from the W3C models and Allen's principles, the standards that do and don't provide it, and the transfer to software agents, with three questions and the status each answer currently has). On 30 October I ruled that these are one thesis, not two: seven chapters, the specification-first argument as the spine and the applied system as its vehicular instantiation. Both pages say how they join. Each is four minutes to read, and each ends with five decisions I would value your view on; the two lists overlap on purpose, and where they differ (the title, the questions) the research-side page says which ruling I have taken and why.

The Work So Far and **The Research Programme** — one each per side: what exists and what it does that I have not found elsewhere, and how it was done so that every number and every claim can be traced.

There is a good deal of work that none of this carries in full: the full pass and exploration from March to May, over a hundred pages of notebooks, which only I can present. The programme documents name it so the shape is visible.

One thing before any chapter. I have used an AI assistant substantively since early this year to organise the corpus, put my results and decisions into prose, cross-check numbers against my traces, and act as a reviewer panel. UBC asks that this be disclosed to and approved by the supervisor in writing before drafts are relied on. The attached one page says what the assistant did and did not do, with the timeline of my own work beside it, and asks for your acknowledgement and approval of the plan from here. The drafting programme that follows is built so that every paragraph shows whose words it is, and I rewrite the AI-drafted prose before

submission. Where the attached documents speak of a “panel”, “lens” or “review”, those are roles the assistant performed under my direction; no one but me has yet reviewed the work.

Because the field and the work are both moving quickly, I’ve frozen the work at 31 October so the dissertation can be finished against a fixed state.

The thesis exists as first full drafts on both sides. Where a result is weaker than first stated, the pages say so.

Anything that comes to mind is welcome, even a line. I’ll follow with the proper update once this thread has a footing.

Best, Nikhil

Variant B — follow-up to the code-side email (if it has gone)

Subject: Re: CVIN — where the thesis stands, November 2026 — the research side

Hi Professor [A], Professor [B],

A short follow-up to yesterday’s note, with the other half of the picture and one thing I should have said first.

The three documents I sent describe the applied system — the nine standards implemented and measured. Attached now are their counterparts for the research side: the twelve-function interface derived from the W3C models and Allen’s principles, the standards inventory and the pre-registered evaluation of eight implementations against it, and the transfer to software agents. On 30 October I ruled that the two sides are one thesis: seven chapters, the specification-first argument as the spine and the applied system as Chapter 6. The new one-pager says exactly how the five questions you have already seen sit inside its three. If you read only one page, read that one.

The thing I should have said first: I have used an AI assistant substantively since early this year to organise the corpus, put my results and decisions into prose, cross-check numbers against my traces, and act as a reviewer panel. UBC asks that this be disclosed and approved in writing before drafts are relied on. The attached one page says what the assistant did and did not do, with the timeline of my own work beside it, and asks for your acknowledgement and your approval of the plan from here. The drafting programme ahead tags every paragraph with its origin so you can see whose words are whose, and I rewrite the AI-drafted prose before submission. Where any of these documents speaks of a “panel”, “examiner” or “review”, those are roles the assistant performed under my direction; no one but me has yet reviewed the work. Please treat yesterday’s documents as covered by the same disclosure.

Same freeze (31 October), same invitation: anything that comes to mind is welcome, even a line.

Best, Nikhil